Ghaznī was also known as Zābulistān and belonged to the Third climate. Some held the view that Qandahār was a part of it. It was situated 14 yīghāch (south-) west of Kābul, and those departing from it at dawn could reach Kābul between the Two Prayers, in the afternoon. In contrast, the 13 yīghāch between Adīnapūr and Kābul could never be covered in one day due to the difficulties of the road.Ghaznī had relatively little cultivated land. A stream, perhaps a four-mill or five-mill one, made the town habitable and irrigated four or five villages, while three or four others relied on underground water-courses (kārez) for cultivation. Grapes in Ghaznī were superior to those in Kābul; melons were more abundant; excellent apples were grown and exported to Hindustan. Agriculture was demanding in Ghaznī because the soil needed fresh top-dressing each year. However, it yielded better returns than Kābul. Ghaznī was known for growing madder, and the entire crop was sent to Hindustan, providing substantial profits for the growers.

The open countryside of Ghaznī was inhabited by Hazāra and Afghāns. It was generally a more affordable place compared to Kābul. The people of Ghaznī adhered to the Ḥanafī faith, were devout and orthodox Muṣalmāns. Many observed a three-month fast, and their wives and children lived in modest seclusion.

Ghaznī was home to notable individuals like Mullā ‘Abdu’r-raḥmān, a learned man who was constantly engaged in learning (dars). He was highly orthodox, pious, and virtuous. He passed away in the same year as Nāṣir Mīrzā (AD 1515). In the suburb known as Rauẓa, where the finest grapes grew, you could find Sultan Maḥmūd’s tomb. This area also housed the tombs of his descendants, including Sultan Mas‘ūd and Sultan Ibrāhīm. Ghaznī boasted many sacred tombs.In the year[9] that Babur took Kābul and Ghaznī, overran Kohāt, the plain of Bannū, and the lands of the Afghāns, and proceeded to Ghaznī via Dūkī (Dūgī) and Āb-istāda, people informed him about a tomb in a Ghaznī village that appeared to move when a benediction on the Prophet was pronounced over it. Babur’s party went to see it. Eventually, Babur discovered that the apparent movement was a trick, most likely orchestrated by the tomb’s attendants. They had placed a platform above it that could be moved when pushed, creating the illusion of the tomb shifting, much like the way the shoreline seems to move for those in a passing boat. Babur ordered the scaffold to be dismantled and a dome to be built over the tomb. He also sternly warned the attendants not to attempt such a deception again. Ghaznī was a very humble place; it was